# Class Notes - 10 October 2026

Topics today: Nobel Peace Prize 2026 | Rapid-fire awards & appointments | China's new air base in Laos, ASEAN, String of Pearls | Shinzo Abe Memorial Corridor (Varanasi) | CATS accreditation (Nameri Tiger Reserve). *Date in class: 10-10-2026.*

**Start of class**

- **Date: 10 October 2026.** Navratri begins **tomorrow** (first day) - so everybody is cheerful. Only **one Nobel award is left** (it will be announced soon); the whole Nobel topic will be covered together once it ends.
- **Thought of the day:** a **winner** is one who tries **one more time after losing again and again**. Example: the viral **Jharkhand** video of a woman running **barefoot in a saree** in the running test after the **Home Guard** exam - it shows the struggles of women who still want to do something for themselves. You have all the facilities, so give your best and 'just win the world'.
- **Announcements:** stay till the **end of class** - a very important thing (which can be checked out for **Rs. 1**) is shared at the end. Class PDF is on **Telegram**. The **Reforms** topic is to be taught today at **11:00** (after this class).
- **Other remarks:** SSC answer keys are out (students reporting scores such as 168, 145, 148 - the teacher said scores look good). Asked whether the SSC **weekly current affairs** is enough: it will do, but 'it is like wanting to sit inside the bus but pushing it from outside' - i.e. do not do the bare minimum.

## TOPIC 1 - Nobel Peace Prize 2026: Navi Pillay

**Question:** Indian-origin **Navanethem Pillay** (known as **Navi Pillay**) was recently honoured with which Nobel? **Answer: Nobel Peace Prize.** Already announced this season: Physics, Chemistry, Medicine - and now Peace.

**Where is it given?**

- **Peace** Nobel is awarded in **Oslo, Norway** - remember **'PO' = Peace & Oslo**.
- All the other Nobel prizes are awarded in **Stockholm, Sweden**.

**Navi Pillay - who is she?**

- **Indian-origin** personality linked to **Tamil Nadu**, but **born in Durban, South Africa** - so **Indo-South African**. (Link the name with hockey player Dhanraj Pillay.)
- Worked as a **judge at the ICC - International Criminal Court**. ICC **HQ: The Hague** (class: 'Hague'); also known by the **Rome Statute**; formed in **1998**.
- Also worked with the **UN Human Rights Council** - class said **2008 to 2014** (no need to memorise the years; just know **where** she worked - two things: **ICC** and **UN human-rights body**).
- **UN Human Rights Council as given in class:** formed **1993**; HQ **New York** (as stated by teacher).
- Reason for award: a lot of work for **human rights** and in **civil/criminal courts**.

**Earlier Peace Nobels (asked in class)**

- **2025: Maria Corina Machado** (**Venezuela**) - she later said she was dedicating her award to **Donald Trump**. 'Many questions came from here last year.'
- **Indians who won earlier - 2014: Kailash Satyarthi**, jointly with **Malala Yousafzai** (Pakistan).

**QUICK REVISION - Nobel Peace**

- 2026 Peace: **Navi Pillay** (Indo-South African, born Durban, Tamil Nadu roots) | ICC judge (HQ **The Hague**, **1998**) + UN human-rights work
- Peace Nobel = **Oslo, Norway** ('PO'); others = **Stockholm, Sweden** | 2025 = **Maria Corina Machado** (Venezuela) | 2014 = **Kailash Satyarthi + Malala**

## TOPIC 2 - Rapid-fire awards, days & appointments

| Question | Answer / details |
|---|---|
| **Miss Universe India 2026** | **'Kaizia Lis'** (name as spoken; audio unclear **[verify]**) |
| **Miss World 2026** | **Dominican Republic** - 'Jari Mola' (as spoken; audio unclear **[verify]**) |
| **National Sports Day** | **29 August** |
| '**Oliy Daraja**' (as spoken: 'Oyli Daraji') - which award? | An award of **Uzbekistan**, given to **PM Modi [verify spelling]** |
| **First CEO of Ram Mandir Trust** | **Jitendra Mishra** |
| BJP MP **Dinesh Sharma** appointed as | **Lieutenant Governor (LG) of Andaman & Nicobar** |
| **Hindi Diwas** (national) / World Hindi Day | **14 September / 10 January** |
| **Engineers' Day** | **15 September** |
| **Alexander Zverev** | Won the **US Open**; from **Germany** |

# Class Notes - 10 October 2026 (continued)

## TOPIC 3 - China's New Air Base in Laos (satellite images)

**Question:** According to satellite images, China is developing a new air base - between China and **Laos**; where is the air base being built? **Answer: in Laos.** The air base is named **'Ban Khun / Ban Kyun'** (as spoken: 'Ban Kyun') **[verify spelling]**.

**Laos - map facts given in class**

- **Landlocked country.** Borders **Thailand** on one side and **Vietnam** on the other (as stated in class); also adjoins China.
- **Capital: Vientiane** (the teacher stressed it is **not** Vietnam's capital).
- On the map, the orange-coloured countries around it are **ASEAN** members.

**ASEAN**

- **South-East Asian Nations** group. Formed **1967**. **HQ: Jakarta.**
- **Total members: 11**; the **newest** is **Timor-Leste**. **India is NOT a member.**
- **2026 ASEAN summit** is being held in the **Philippines**.

**Why is China building the base?**

- To **improve relations with ASEAN countries** and to **keep watch over the whole of South (Asia)** from this base (as stated in class).
- **Earlier base:** China developed one in **Djibouti** (a country) - work since **2017**.
- China's strategy around India = **'String of Pearls'**; India's counter-strategy = **'Necklace of Diamonds'** (important for the paper).
- **BRI - Belt and Road Initiative:** China develops and keeps watch in different countries; **since 2013**.
- **Example - Sri Lanka:** China built **Hambantota Port**, then demanded money back; Sri Lanka could not pay, so China took it on a **99-year lease**.

**QUICK REVISION - China, Laos & ASEAN**

- New Chinese air base in **Laos** (landlocked; capital **Vientiane**; borders Thailand & Vietnam) - base name **Ban Khun/Kyun** [verify]
- **ASEAN**: **1967**, HQ **Jakarta**, **11** members, newest **Timor-Leste**, **India not a member**, 2026 summit **Philippines**
- China: **String of Pearls** | India: **Necklace of Diamonds** | **BRI** since **2013** | Djibouti base (**2017**) | **Hambantota** - **99-year lease**

## TOPIC 4 - Shinzo Abe Memorial Corridor, Varanasi

**Question: Akie Abe** (wife of Shinzo Abe) is in India and inaugurated the **Shinzo Abe Memorial Corridor**. **Where? Answer: Varanasi.**

- **Inaugurated by: Akie Abe** together with **CM of UP, Yogi Adityanath**. **Venue: Rudraksh Convention Centre**, Varanasi.
- **Varanasi:** in **Uttar Pradesh**, on the bank of the **Ganga**; old name **Kashi**.
- **2015:** Shinzo Abe visited **Varanasi** with **PM Modi** and attended the **Ganga Aarti** - it showed India-Japan relations as very close.
- Abe said: as India has **Kashi**, Japan has **Kyoto** (transcript: 'Kato') - showing the bond/'beauty of the city'. The memorial now symbolises **India-Japan relations**.
- **Shinzo Abe: PM of Japan**, **two terms**; class gave tenure **2012 to 2020**. He has since **died**. India honoured him with the **Padma Vibhushan in 2021**.

# Class Notes - 10 October 2026 (continued)

**QUICK REVISION - Shinzo Abe Memorial Corridor**

- **Varanasi (Kashi)**, UP, on the Ganga | opened by **Akie Abe + Yogi Adityanath** at **Rudraksh Convention Centre**
- Abe: PM of Japan, two terms (2012-2020 as per class) | visited Varanasi **2015** with Modi, Ganga Aarti | **Padma Vibhushan 2021** | Kashi - Kyoto link

## Related quick questions asked in class

| Question | Answer / details |
|---|---|
| **'Kyoto'** Protocol - linked with what? | **Climate change** (Kyoto Protocol). |
| Where was the **Ganga Aarti** performed recently (abroad)? | **London**, on the bank of the **River Thames**. |
| Who is the **CM of UP**? | **Yogi Adityanath**. |
| Who was **Shinzo Abe**? | **PM of Japan** - two terms (2012-2020 as stated); Padma Vibhushan 2021. |

## TOPIC 5 - CATS: Conservation Assured Tiger Standards

**Question:** Which tiger reserve was recently given **CATS** approval / status for tiger conservation? **Answer: Nameri Tiger Reserve** (as spoken: 'Na meri, na teri - that is Nameri') - in **Assam**.

**CATS**

- **Full form: Conservation Assured Tiger Standards** - 'the paper asks the full form again and again'.
- It gives a **status/accreditation** that says a reserve can **conserve tigers** well (meets standards).

**Assam parks & reserves mentioned (all in Assam)**

- **Kaziranga** - in **Assam**; famous for **rhinos**.
- **Manas National Park** - Assam, on the bank of the **Manas river**; **tigers**, **elephants** and other species are found.
- **Orang Tiger Reserve** - also in **Assam**; its **name was changed recently**.
- **Nameri** - Assam - the reserve that received the CATS status.

**QUICK REVISION - CATS**

- **CATS** = **Conservation Assured Tiger Standards** | recent: **Nameri Tiger Reserve** (Assam)
- Assam: **Kaziranga** (rhinos) | **Manas** (Manas river; tigers + elephants) | **Orang** (name changed) | **Nameri**

**Note about this transcript**

- The recording **ends abruptly** in the middle of the CATS topic (the last words are cut off), so anything taught after this point is **not** included. The teacher also said some important item would be told at the **end of class (Rs. 1 check-out)** and that the **Reforms** topic would follow at 11:00 - neither is in the text provided.

## ALL MCQs from the Class - 10 October 2026

Every question asked in class, with the answer given. Items marked **[verify]** were unclear in the recording.

1. **Indian-origin Navanethem (Navi) Pillay was honoured with which Nobel?**
   Ans: **Nobel Peace Prize** (2026)
2. **Where is the Nobel Peace Prize awarded? Other Nobels?**
   Ans: **Oslo, Norway** ('PO'); others in **Stockholm, Sweden**
3. **Navi Pillay: born where? Roots?**
   Ans: Born in **Durban, South Africa**; roots in **Tamil Nadu**
4. **In which court did Navi Pillay work as a judge? HQ? Formed?**
   Ans: **ICC** (International Criminal Court); **The Hague**; **1998**
5. **UN Human Rights Council - formed (class)? HQ (class)?**
   Ans: **1993**; **New York** (as stated)
6. **Nobel Peace Prize 2025 winner? Country?**
   Ans: **Maria Corina Machado**; **Venezuela**
7. **Which Indian won the Peace Nobel in 2014 (with whom)?**
   Ans: **Kailash Satyarthi** (with **Malala Yousafzai**)
8. **Miss Universe India 2026 title winner?**
   Ans: **'Kaizia Lis'** (as spoken) **[verify]**
9. **When is National Sports Day celebrated?**
   Ans: **29 August**
10. **'Oliy Daraja' award belongs to which country? Given to?**
    Ans: **Uzbekistan**; **PM Modi [verify]**
11. **Where is China building a new air base (satellite images)?**
    Ans: **Laos** (base: Ban Khun/Kyun **[verify]**)
12. **Laos - landlocked? Capital?**
    Ans: **Yes, landlocked**; **Vientiane**
13. **ASEAN formed? HQ? Members? Newest member?**
    Ans: **1967**; **Jakarta**; **11**; **Timor-Leste**
14. **Is India an ASEAN member?**
    Ans: **No**
15. **Where is the 2026 ASEAN summit?**
    Ans: **Philippines**
16. **China developed an earlier base in which country (since 2017)?**
    Ans: **Djibouti**
17. **China's strategy around India? India's counter-strategy?**
    Ans: **String of Pearls**; **Necklace of Diamonds**
18. **BRI full form? Since when?**
    Ans: **Belt and Road Initiative**; **2013**
19. **Which Sri Lankan port was leased to China? For how long?**
    Ans: **Hambantota**; **99 years**
20. **First CEO of the Ram Mandir Trust?**
    Ans: **Jitendra Mishra**
21. **Miss World 2026?**
    Ans: **Dominican Republic** ('Jari Mola') **[verify]**
22. **BJP MP Dinesh Sharma appointed as?**
    Ans: **LG of Andaman & Nicobar**
23. **Shinzo Abe Memorial Corridor inaugurated where? By whom?**
    Ans: **Varanasi**; **Akie Abe + CM Yogi Adityanath**
24. **Venue of the inauguration?**
    Ans: **Rudraksh Convention Centre**, Varanasi
25. **Old name of Varanasi? Japan's counterpart city?**
    Ans: **Kashi**; **Kyoto**
26. **Shinzo Abe - who? Tenure? Padma award?**
    Ans: **PM of Japan**; **2012-2020** (as stated); **Padma Vibhushan 2021**
27. **Year Abe visited Varanasi with Modi?**
    Ans: **2015** (attended Ganga Aarti)
28. **Kyoto Protocol is associated with?**
    Ans: **Climate change**
29. **Ganga Aarti recently held in which city / river?**
    Ans: **London**; **River Thames**
30. **National Hindi Diwas? World Hindi Day?**
    Ans: **14 September**; **10 January**
31. **Engineers' Day?**
    Ans: **15 September**
32. **Alexander Zverev won which title? From which country?**
    Ans: **US Open**; **Germany**
33. **Which tiger reserve recently got CATS status?**
    Ans: **Nameri** (Assam)
34. **CATS full form?**
    Ans: **Conservation Assured Tiger Standards**
35. **Kaziranga (Assam) is known for? Manas is on which river?**
    Ans: **Rhinos**; **Manas river** (tigers, elephants)
36. **Which Assam tiger reserve's name was recently changed?**
    Ans: **Orang Tiger Reserve**